

How the beef carcass grade gets decided

An executive overview of the scorecard behind Calibra's beef carcass grading — for leadership and grading-desk stakeholders.

Prepared 14 Sep 2026 · **Updated** 23 Sep 2026

Scope BG1021 (steer) — lamb & goat remain manual · **Mode** shadow (advisory)

6

visual attributes scored
per carcass

0–18

Verdict 1 point range

5

carcass weight tiers
(200–300kg ceiling)

7

possible outcomes (6
sellable + Condemned)

How a carcass is graded

Every BG1021 carcass runs through the same scorecard, worked from the reference grading sheet. Four conditions can decide the outcome outright before any score is tallied — see **Automatic overrides** below. Otherwise, as of 23 Sep 2026, settlement weight is required to finalize every grade, not just to break ties.

- 01** QA scores six visual attributes — **Dentition, Fat Cover, Bruising/Blemishes, Fat Colour, Meat Colour, Muscle Conformation** — and the points sum to `verdict1` .
- 02** `verdict1` is checked against every grade's scoring band. The bands **overlap by design** — FAQ and Standard, for instance, share the same floor of 10 — so one score can land inside more than one grade at once.
- 03** Settlement weight is now **required to finalize** any grade — even when only one band fits. Until the carcass is weighed, the system offers that grade only as a provisional suggestion, flagged `awaiting weight` ; QA can still grade manually in the meantime.
- 04** Once weight is known, it's banded into five tiers and can only ever pull the grade **down, never up**: `verdict2 = verdict1 + weight_tier` . If more than one band fit, weight decides between them; if only one band fit, weight can still downgrade it further.
- 05** If settlement weight falls outside every defined band (heavier than the Premium ceiling), or the grade still can't be resolved to one outcome even with weight applied, the carcass is **flagged for QA review** rather than guessed at.
- 06** The system records its own suggestion alongside whatever QA finally saves — it never overwrites their call. That's **shadow mode**, on the last page.

AUTOMATIC OVERRIDES

Four conditions decide the outcome outright, regardless of score. When more than one applies at once, the **worst outcome wins** — Condemned beats Poor C beats Commercial.

- Fat Cover = None → automatic **Commercial**, regardless of all other scores.
- Bruising = Detained → automatic **Poor C**, regardless of all other scores.
- Muscle Conformation = Poorly conformed → automatic **Poor C**, regardless of all other scores.
- Bruising = Condemned → **Condemned** — not a sellable grade; recorded on the settlement sheet, not scored on this matrix at all.

Points by attribute

What QA actually selects for each of the six attributes, and the points each option carries toward Verdict 1.

DENTITION

Full mouth	1
3 pairs	2
2 pairs	3
1 pair	3
Milk teeth	3

FAT COVER

Marbling (heavy, well-marbled)	4
Good (3–10mm+, even)	3
Fair (2–7mm)	2
Minimum/inadequate	1
None	0

† None also triggers an automatic override to Commercial — see previous page.

FAT COLOUR

Cream white	3
Light yellow	2
Deep yellow	1

MEAT COLOUR

Bright red	2
Dark	1

BRUISING / BLEMISHES	
No bruises	3
Mild bruises	2
Severe bruises	1
Detained †	1
Condemned †	0
† Detained/Condemned also trigger an automatic override — see previous page.	

MUSCLE CONFORMATION	
Well finished (thick flesh)	3
Fairly conformed	2
Poorly conformed †	1
† Poorly conformed also triggers an automatic override to Poor C.	

Grade bands

Where each grade's Verdict 1 range sits, and the weight tier it needs to finalize.

GRADE	VERDICT 1 BAND	WEIGHT TIER REQUIRED
Premium	17–18	Tier 5 — 200–300kg
High Grade	13–17	Tier 4 — 170–199.9kg
FAQ	10–15	Tier 3 — 150–169.9kg
Standard	10–16	Tier 2 — 120–149.9kg
Commercial	8–14	Tier 1 — below 120kg
Poor C	0–7	No weight floor of its own
Condemned	—	Automatic override only (Bruising = Condemned); not scored

Above 300kg, weight falls outside every band — the carcass is flagged for QA review, not assumed Premium.

Weight bands

Five bands, drawn from the reference sheet's weight table. Weight can only ever pull a grade down from what the visual score alone suggests — never up — and, as of 23 Sep 2026, is required to finalize every grade, not just to break ties.

TIER 1 Commercial below 120kg	TIER 2 Standard 120–149.9kg	TIER 3 FAQ 150–169.9kg	TIER 4 High Grade 170–199.9kg	TIER 5 Premium 200–300kg
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SHADOW MODE

The scorecard computes `verdict1` / `verdict2` / `auto_classification` for every carcass and stores it alongside whatever grade QA actually saves — it suggests, never decides. Each saved row is tagged **auto** or **manual** depending on whether QA's own choice matched the suggestion.

A `flagged` marker covers cases the system couldn't confidently resolve — a tie weight didn't settle, or a weight outside the expected range. An `awaiting_weight` marker shows suggestions still waiting on the carcass being weighed. Automatic overrides (above) bypass scoring entirely and are never flagged.

That agreement trail is what tells us when it's safe to let the system decide on its own — it isn't there yet.

Live for **BG1021 steer carcasses only**. Lamb and goat keep their existing manual grading, unchanged.

Prepared from the QA grading system · internal use
Updated 23 Sep 2026 (originally prepared 14 Sep 2026) — see **Automatic overrides** and **Weight bands** for what changed since the first version.
Accent ink echoes the violet, food-safe dye used on physical grade stamps.